## WHAT WE SHOULD DO

In this final section I put forward a few practical recommendations. These are a bare minimum in number, and rather long- and medium-term in scope, but nevertheless important to consider for the security of the Myanmar–Bangladesh border region.

### *Effective identification of people and control of the border*

The population either side of the international border — both in Bangladesh and Myanmar — should be readily identifiable. Procedures for identification should be periodically reviewed. The Rohingya people who have migrated into Bangladesh but are not officially documented (that is, those outside the UNHCR camps in Cox's Bazar) may be registered as Myanmar residents, and not as Bangladeshi citizens. Also, external controls at the border need to be accompanied by appropriate sets of internal controls, something the Bangladeshi authorities seem to lack. Commendably, in the last few years, the local authorities of Cox's Bazar District have introduced stricter verification measures — especially for issuing residents' passports — that could be replicated in other services and sectors.

### *Freedom of action for local and international agencies*

The recent signs of democratic transition in Myanmar call for increased involvement by local and international agencies in strengthening an organized civil society, encouraging constructive dialogue, and overseeing long-term strategies that assist all population groups in Myanmar (HEI 2008). These agencies — especially the UNHCR (which has offices in both Maungdaw and Teknaf) — could be extremely useful in instilling confidence among the Rohingya people so that they do not seek relocation away from their ancestral lands in Rakhine State. This task will require cooperation from the respective authorities in Myanmar. The Bangladesh government should also prevent the local people of Teknaf and Cox's Bazar from pursuing personal gain by providing illegal support for people emigrating from Myanmar. Ultimately, a long-term solution to Myanmar's Rohingya problem lies in a peaceful and stable Rakhine State, and not in hundreds of well-supplied and well-fed UNHCR camps in Teknaf or Maungdaw.